

The King Of Image Management

It's something like music: everybody loves playing around with images—whether it's painting, altering colours, lending special effects, or even serious stuff like retouching photographs. The problem is, you need a good tool to be able to do these things, and most folks think Photoshop is too complex. We've got news—it's not!

When someone learns a few Photoshop tricks, his stock value instantly rises—"Wow, he can actually give a sepia tone to a picture!" or "He can use Photoshop to make cut-outs of wallpapers!" Well, our idea when we were writing this was that you should be able to teach such folks a thing or two or more. We've said Photoshop isn't complex, and by the time you're through with this little book, you should be able to do most of the common stuff—and some really cool stuff—that Adobe Photoshop is capable of. We're not claiming you'll become an expert: you'd need a few years and a few thousands of rupees in books for that.

What follows is organised this way: we first talk about the basics of editing pictures. Selections follow: these are important because you sometimes want to modify only part of an image. Layers come next—you have, in all probability, heard about layers in Photoshop. The next chapter is about advanced effects—really fun stuff you can do. After that, we get a little serious, and talk about getting some work done—like retouching old photographs and such. Vectors, shapes, and masks follow: you'll figure out soon enough what these are. We then touch upon image formats, and ImageReady—which is something like Photoshop for the Web. Towards the end, we talk about how to prepare your photos for print, and wrap up with some cool projects you can undertake.

We've used Photoshop CS2 for all the work and projects in the book. You can find the CS2 tryout on this month's DVD. The images used in the workshops are on the Digit CD.

Photoshop is great fun. But be warned: it's also addictive!